



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

ity* evam uktaḥ sa* ratha+praṇetā |
nivedayām āsa nṛ+pa+ātma+jāya |
saṃrakṣyam apy* artham a+doṣa+darśī |
tair* eva devaiḥ kṛta+buddhi+mohaḥ || 3.29 |
rūpasya (hantrī Chartrī)vyasanaṃ* balasya |
śokasya yonir* nidhanaṃ* ratīnām |
nāśaḥ smṛtīnām* ripur* indriyāṇām |
eṣā jarā nāma yayā*eṣa bhagnaḥ || 3.30 |

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 3, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Having been thus addressed, the charioteer reveals the truth to the prince, Siddhartha. Even though it was something normally hidden, the charioteer, guided by divine influence, presents the stark reality of aging. He describes old age as the destroyer of beauty, the ruin of strength, the birthplace of sorrow, the death of joys, the loss of memory, and the enemy of the senses. He shows Siddhartha a broken, aged figure, revealing the inevitable decline that awaits all beings.

This passage is a pivotal moment in Siddhartha's journey, shattering his sheltered existence and forcing him to confront the universal truths of suffering and impermanence. It's not simply about physical decay, but a deeper commentary on the nature of existence. The "divine influence" suggests that this revelation wasn't accidental; it was a necessary catalyst for Siddhartha's awakening. The gods, in a sense, orchestrated this confrontation with reality.

For you, this scripture offers a powerful reminder to confront your own illusions and accept the inevitable changes of life. You, like Siddhartha, may be tempted to shield yourself from uncomfortable truths – about aging, illness, loss, or even your own mortality. But true wisdom lies in acknowledging these realities and understanding their place in the grand scheme of things. Modern society often glorifies youth and vitality, pushing aging into the shadows. This passage urges you to resist this cultural pressure and embrace the full spectrum of life, including its challenges. By accepting impermanence, you can cultivate a deeper appreciation for the present moment and find peace amidst the inevitable changes. Recognize that clinging to illusions of permanence only leads to suffering. Instead, embrace the flow of life, learning from each stage and finding meaning in every experience.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you cultivate a greater sense of acceptance towards the inevitable changes in your life and find peace in the present moment?